A FORMALLY VERIFIED HEXADECIMAL DIGIT EXTRACTION FOR π WITH AN EXPLICIT GUARD FOR EVERY POSITION

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Abstract. We describe a Lean 4 development, built on Mathlib, about the Bailey–Borwein–Plouffe (BBP) formula for π. It contains an independent proof that the BBP series equals π, an integer-only certificate for the hexadecimal digit $d_n = \lfloor 16^n \pi \rfloor \bmod 16$, and a soundness theorem: when the two ends of the certificate's bracket agree, the certified digit is the true digit. To remove the dependence on that check, we formalize an explicit irrationality-measure bound at the denominators 16^k: for every $k \geq 1$ and every integer p, $|16^k\pi - p| \cdot 16^{570k} > 2^{-7182802} \cdot 16^k$. From it we prove that for every $n \geq 0$ and every $g \geq 569n + \lfloor \log_{16}(n+1) \rfloor + 1 + 1\,795\,710$ the certificate at guard depth g returns d_n; a simpler sufficient condition is $g \geq 570n + 1\,795\,711$. We also prove a short chain of exact statements relating the run of 0s or Fs after position n, the distance from $16^n\pi$ to the nearest integer, and the least sufficient guard depth. All statements are for every n or for explicit finite ranges; no asymptotic, probabilistic or normality claim is made. The proofs use only the axioms `propext`, `Classical.choice` and `Quot.sound`, and no `native_decide`.

1. Introduction

The BBP formula [1]

$$\pi = \sum_{k \geq 0} \frac{1}{16^k} \left(\frac{4}{8k+1} - \frac{2}{8k+4} - \frac{1}{8k+5} - \frac{1}{8k+6} \right) \tag{1}$$

lets one compute the hexadecimal digit of π at position n without computing the earlier digits. Every implementation computes a finite sum to finite precision, so the algorithm needs a *guard*: enough extra digits that the rounding error cannot change the digit being extracted. How many extra digits are enough depends on how close $16^n\pi$ is to an integer, which is a Diophantine question about π.

This paper reports a Lean 4 [8] development that makes the guard explicit and proves it sufficient for every position. We use the following conventions throughout. For $n \in \mathbb{N}$ let

$$x_n = 16^n \pi, \qquad d_n = \lfloor x_n \rfloor \bmod 16, \qquad \delta_n = \min\big(\{x_n\},\, 1 - \{x_n\}\big),$$

so $d_0 = 3$, $d_1 = 2$, $d_2 = 4$, and δ_n is the distance from x_n to the nearest integer. The certificate at guard depth g uses $K = n + g + 1$ terms, an integer sum $S_{n,g} \in \mathbb{N}$, an error allowance $E_{n,g} = 4K + 2$, and returns $\lfloor (S_{n,g} \mathbin{\dot{-}} E_{n,g})/16^g \rfloor \bmod 16$ (Section 4).

Contributions.

(1) An independent Lean proof of (1) (Theorem 3.1). Earlier formal proofs exist in Coq and in Lean; see Section 2.
(2) An integer-only digit certificate with a soundness theorem (Theorem 4.2) and a distance criterion: if $2E_{n,g} < 16^g \delta_n$ the bracket collapses (Lemma 4.3).

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(3) A formal irrationality-measure bound at the denominators 16^k with exponent 570 and an explicit constant (Theorem 5.1).
(4) For every n, an explicit guard depth at which the certificate is proved to return d_n (Theorem 6.1).
(5) Exact relations between the 0/F run after position n, the distance δ_n and the least sufficient guard depth, together with a kernel-checked example showing that one natural converse fails (Section 7).

We make no claim about normality or about the statistics of the digits of π. Statements of the form "for every n" are theorems; statements about finite ranges of digits are labeled either as kernel-checked theorems or as computed numerics, and the latter are not used in any proof.

Status of the capped certificate. The development also contains an earlier certificate that searches only the guard depths $4, 8, \ldots, 64$ and falls back to 68. It is proved correct for $n \leq 10000$ and proved incorrect on an explicit window near 2^{272}; between these ranges it is neither proved correct nor proved incorrect. Appendix A describes these results. They are not part of the main theorem.

2. Related work

Formal proofs about the BBP formula. Bertot, Rideau and Théry [2] formalized in Coq a proof of the BBP formula and a digit-extraction routine, and used it to compute the billionth hexadecimal digit of π inside Coq; the code is available as [9]. Their correctness statement for the digit routine is a partial-correctness statement: when the routine returns a digit, that digit is correct. As the authors note, a routine that never returns a digit would also satisfy it. They also note that the HOL Light library contains a formalization of the BBP formula. Our Theorem 4.2 plays the same role as their partial-correctness statement; the difference is Theorem 6.1, which supplies, for every n, a guard depth at which the check is proved to pass.

In Lean, Braams's lean-DLMF project [3] contains the theorem `hasSum_bbp_pi`, the BBP formula in Mathlib's `HasSum` form. That file was first committed publicly on 16 October 2026. Our proof of Theorem 3.1 was developed independently and uses a different route (an integral representation, see Section 3). We do not claim priority for the identity.

Irrationality measures of π. Mahler [5] proved the first explicit bound, $|\pi - p/q| > q^{-42}$ for all integers p and $q \geq 2$. Mignotte [6] lowered the exponent to about 20, and the best published bound we know of in a refereed journal is $7.103205334137\ldots$ by Zeilberger and Zudilin [10]. Our formal exponent 570 is far from these values; it comes from a deliberately simple instance of Mahler's method in which every constant is made explicit and checked in Lean (Section 5). What the application needs is not a small exponent but an explicit constant valid for every $k \geq 1$.

Other formal work. Mathlib [8] proves that π is irrational, and Eberl's Isabelle formalization [4] proves that π is transcendental. The Prove2Me platform [7] hosts a campaign of Lean formulations of irrationality-measure bounds for π, from Mahler's exponent 42 to the value 2 claimed in a 2026 preprint; on 31 October 2026 its campaign page listed all of these missions as completed. The goal statements we inspected there are in the form "for every $\varepsilon > 0$ there is a threshold Q", which asserts the existence of a threshold without giving one. A guard depth needs a threshold and a constant that are explicit, so we do not use those results, and we have not audited them.

3. The BBP identity

Theorem 3.1 (`bbpSeries_eq_pi`)**.** *The series* (1) *converges and its sum is* π*.*

Outline of the formal proof. Write $p(x) = 4 - 2x^3 - x^4 - x^5$. Since $\int_0^1 x^{8k+j-1}\,dx = 1/(8k+j)$, the k-th summand equals $\int_0^1 (x^8/16)^k\, p(x)\,dx$. Dominated convergence for the geometric series gives

$$\sum_{k\ge 0} \frac{1}{16^k}\Big(\cdots\Big) = \int_0^1 \frac{p(x)}{1 - x^8/16}\,dx.$$

The factorizations $16 - x^8 = -(x^2-2)(x^2+2)(x^2+2x+2)(x^2-2x+2)$ and $p(x) = -(x-1)(x^2+2)(x^2+2x+2)$ reduce the integrand to $16(x-1)/\big((x^2-2)(x^2-2x+2)\big)$, which has the antiderivative $F(x) = 2\log(2-x^2) - 2\log(x^2-2x+2) + 4\arctan(x-1)$ on $[0,1]$. Then $F(1) - F(0) = \pi$ by the fundamental theorem of calculus. □

```
theorem bbpSeries_eq_pi : bbpSeries = Real.pi
```

4. The digit certificate and its soundness

Definition 4.1 (certificate)**.** For $k, N \in \mathbb{N}$ let

$$t_k(N) = \left\lfloor \frac{4\cdot 16^N}{16^k(8k+1)} \right\rfloor \dot{-} \left\lfloor \frac{2\cdot 16^N}{16^k(8k+4)} \right\rfloor \dot{-} \left\lfloor \frac{16^N}{16^k(8k+5)} \right\rfloor \dot{-} \left\lfloor \frac{16^N}{16^k(8k+6)} \right\rfloor,$$

where $\dot{-}$ is truncated subtraction on $\mathbb{N}$. For $n, g \in \mathbb{N}$ put $K = n + g + 1$ and

$$S_{n,g} = \sum_{k<K} t_k(n+g) \in \mathbb{N}, \qquad E_{n,g} = 4K + 2, \qquad \mathrm{lo} = \left\lfloor \frac{S_{n,g} \dot{-} E_{n,g}}{16^g} \right\rfloor, \qquad \mathrm{hi} = \left\lfloor \frac{S_{n,g} + E_{n,g}}{16^g} \right\rfloor.$$

The guard *agrees at depth* g if $\mathrm{lo} = \mathrm{hi}$. The certified floor is lo and the certified digit is $\mathrm{lo} \bmod 16$.

In Lean these are `bbpSpigotTerm`, `bbpGuardedSum`, `bbpGuardErr`, `bbpGuardedLo`, `bbpGuardedHi`, `BBPGuardAgreesAt`, `bbpCertFloorAt` and `bbpCertDigitAt`. Everything is computed in $\mathbb{N}$. The lemma `bbp_term_cast_bounds` shows that the truncated subtractions in $t_k(N)$ never truncate and that

$$16^N a_k - 1 < t_k(N) < 16^N a_k + 3,$$

where a_k is the k-th summand of (1). Summing over $k < K$ and bounding the tail of the series by 1 gives

$$\mathrm{lo} \le x_n < \mathrm{hi} + 1 \qquad (\texttt{bbpGuarded_bracket}).$$

Theorem 4.2 (soundness; `BBPGuardAgreesAt.floor_pi`, `BBPGuardAgreesAt.digit_pi`)**.** *For all* $n, g \in \mathbb{N}$*, if the guard agrees at depth* g*, then* $\lfloor x_n \rfloor = \mathrm{lo}$ *and* $\mathrm{lo} \bmod 16 = d_n$*.*

Proof. If $\mathrm{lo} = \mathrm{hi}$ the bracket gives $\mathrm{lo} \le x_n < \mathrm{lo} + 1$, so $\mathrm{lo} = \lfloor x_n \rfloor$; Theorem 3.1 replaces the series by π. □

Agreement is decidable, so for any particular (n, g) the hypothesis can be discharged by evaluation in the kernel. The next lemma gives a sufficient condition in terms of δ_n.

Lemma 4.3 (`guardAgreesAt_of_dist`)**.** *Let* $n, g \in \mathbb{N}$*. If* $2E_{n,g} < 16^g |x_n - m|$ *for every* $m \in \mathbb{Z}$*, then the guard agrees at depth* g*. In particular this holds when* $2E_{n,g} < 16^g \delta_n$*.*

The factor 2 accounts for one $E_{n,g}$ from the error of $S_{n,g}$ and one from the width of the bracket. Since $2E_{n,g} = 8n + 8g + 12$ grows linearly in g while 16^g grows exponentially, Lemma 4.3 reduces the choice of a guard to a lower bound for δ_n.

5. An irrationality measure at the denominators 16^k

Theorem 5.1 (`MahlerSharp7b.pi_pow16_measure7`)**.** *For every integer $k \geq 1$ and every $p \in \mathbb{Z}$,*

$$|16^k\pi - p| \cdot 16^{570k} > 2^{-7182802} \cdot 16^k.$$

```
theorem pi_pow16_measure7 :
     k :  , 1   k →   p :  ,
      |(16 :  ) ^ k * Real.pi - p| * (16 :  ) ^ (k * 570)
        > (1 / 2 ^ (7182801 + 1)) * (16 :  ) ^ k
```

Equivalently, with $q = 16^k$, $|\pi - p/q| > 2^{-7182802} q^{-570}$; so the statement is an irrationality-measure bound with exponent 570 and an explicit constant, restricted to the denominators that the digit application uses.

Structure of the formal proof. The proof follows Mahler's method [5], in the form used by Mignotte [6], with every constant explicit. We list the ingredients in the order in which they are combined.

(1) *Chebyshev bound.* From Mathlib's bound for the Chebyshev function ψ and the estimate $2\sqrt{x}\log x \leq 0.02x + 8760$ for $x \geq 1$ we obtain $\psi(x) \leq (\log 4 + 0.02)x + 8760$ (`psi_le_lin7`), hence $\operatorname{lcm}(1, \ldots, n) \leq \exp(1.4063\, n + 8760)$ (`lcm_le_exp_lin7`). Here 1.4063 is a rational upper bound for $\log 4 + 0.02$.

(2) *Remainder.* For $n \geq 1000$ the auxiliary remainder terms satisfy a tail bound of the form $(8.55/(m+1))^J$ (`remainder_sharp7`); this uses $\pi e < 8.5398$. Specialized to $m = 141$ and $n = 4k + 12600$, it gives the smallness hypothesis of the next step for every $h \leq 141$ (`remainder_spec7`).

(3) *Mahler–Mignotte step.* A nonvanishing determinant argument (`pi_lower_bound_sharp`) shows that whenever $|\pi - p/q| \leq 1$,

$$1 \leq (2q)^m \, |\pi - p/q| \, T,$$

where T collects the size of the auxiliary coefficients.

(4) *Size of T.* With $m = 141$ and $n = 4k + 12600$, the bound $T \leq 2^{7182660 + 1716k}$ holds for every k (`T_spec7`).

(5) *Exponent arithmetic.* With $q = 16^k$ we have $(2q)^{141} = 2^{141 + 564k}$, so $|\pi - p/q| \geq 2^{-(141+7182660)} \cdot 2^{-(564+1716)k}$. Since $141 + 7182660 = 7182801$ and $564 + 1716 = 2280 = 4 \cdot 570$, this is $2^{-7182801}\, 16^{-570k}$. Passing to the strict inequality costs one more factor of 2, which gives the constant $2^{-7182802}$. The case $|\pi - p/q| > 1$ is immediate.

The remaining parameters ($m = 141$, the offset 12600, the constants 0.02 and 8760) were chosen numerically to keep the exponent and the constant moderate; the choice affects only the size of the constants, never correctness. □

Remark 5.2. The same development contains an earlier bound with exponent 658 and constant $2^{-1720001}$ (`MahlerSharp.pi_pow16_measure6`), used in Remark 6.3.

6. The main theorem: an explicit guard for every position

Combining Lemma 4.3 with Theorem 5.1 gives a guard depth that is sufficient for every n. Define

$$g(n) = 569n + \lfloor \log_{16}(n+1) \rfloor + 1 + B, \qquad B = 1\,795\,710.$$

Theorem 6.1 (`bbp_digit_all_n_mu570b`). *For every $n \in \mathbb{N}$, the guard agrees at depth $g(n)$, and*

$$\lfloor 16^n \pi \rfloor = \mathrm{lo}(n, g(n)), \qquad \mathrm{lo}(n, g(n)) \bmod 16 = d_n.$$

Moreover the same holds at every depth $g \geq g(n)$ (`bbp_guard_mu570b_of_ge`).

Corollary 6.2 (`bbp_digit_all_n_fixed7b`). *For all $n, g \in \mathbb{N}$ with $g \geq 570n + 1\,795\,711$, the certificate at depth g returns $\lfloor 16^n \pi \rfloor$ and d_n.*

```
theorem bbp_digit_all_n_mu570b (n :  ) :
     (16 :  ) ^ n * Real.pi =
        (bbpCertFloorAt n (569 * n + (Nat.log 16 (n + 1) + 1) + 1795710) :  )
      bbpCertDigitAt n (569 * n + (Nat.log 16 (n + 1) + 1) + 1795710)
        = bbpHexDigitReal n

theorem bbp_digit_all_n_fixed7b (n g :  ) (hg : 570 * n + 1795711   g) :
     (16 :  ) ^ n * Real.pi = (bbpCertFloorAt n g :  )
      bbpCertDigitAt n g = bbpHexDigitReal n
```

Outline. Write $g = 569n + L + j$ with $L = \lfloor \log_{16}(n+1) \rfloor + 1$, so that $n + 1 \leq 16^L$. The generic lemma `guard_agrees_of_const` shows that $\mathrm{BBPGuardAgreesAt}(n, g)$ holds for every n as soon as $j \geq 1$ and $(8{\cdot}570{+}20)(j{+}1) \leq 2^{-7182802}\, 16^j$. For $n \geq 1$ it combines Theorem 5.1 (with $k = n$), which gives $\delta_n > 2^{-7182802}\, 16^{-569n}$, with Lemma 4.3; for $n = 0$ it uses a direct lower bound for the distance from π to the nearest integer. The constant is computed exactly in Lean: $\ell = \lfloor \log_{16} \lceil 4580 \cdot 2^{7182802} \rceil \rfloor + 1 = 1795704$ (`guardLogL_570b`), since $4580 \cdot 2^{7182802} = 18320 \cdot 16^{1795700}$, and $j = \ell + \lfloor \log_{16}(2\ell) \rfloor + 1 = 1795704 + 5 + 1 = 1\,795\,710$ (`guardLogConst_570b`). Corollary 6.2 follows from monotonicity in g and $\lfloor \log_{16}(n+1) \rfloor \leq n$. □

Remark 6.3 (the exponent-658 guard). The earlier bound gives the guard $657n + \lfloor \log_{16}(n{+}1) \rfloor + 1{+}430009$ (`bbp_digit_all_n_mu658`), also proved for every n. It exceeds $g(n)$ by $88n - 1365701$, so it is the smaller of the two for $n \leq 15519$ and the larger for $n \geq 15520$. Both theorems hold for every n, so one can take the minimum.

How far the proved guard is from what is needed. Let $\nu(n)$ be the least g with $2E_{n,g} < 16^g \delta_n$ (in Lean, `piNeed`; it exists because π is irrational). Table 1 compares the proved guards with $\nu(n)$ at a few positions. The column $\nu(n)$ is *computed numerics*, obtained with `mpmath` at precision $4n + 400$ bits; it is not a Lean theorem and no result in this paper depends on it. The other columns are values of the formulas in Theorem 6.1, Corollary 6.2 and Remark 6.3.

The proved guards are very far from $\nu(n)$. They are meant as a correctness guarantee for every position, not as a practical precision choice: in practice one runs the decidable check of Theorem 4.2 at a small depth, and Theorem 6.1 guarantees that a depth at which the check passes exists and is at most $g(n)$.

7. Runs, distance and need

This section relates three quantities attached to a position n. All results are theorems for every n, except where an explicit range is stated.

Definition 7.1. Let $\rho(n)$ be the length of the maximal block of equal digits starting at position $n + 1$ that consists only of 0s or only of Fs (`piRun`; $\rho(n) = 0$ if $d_{n+1} \notin \{0, \mathrm{F}\}$). For $s \in \mathbb{N}$, if some digit d_{s+k} with $k \geq 0$ equals 1, let $\gamma(s)$ be the least such k (`piGapSeq`).

TABLE 1. Proved guard depths and the least sufficient depth $\nu(n)$. The last column is computed numerics, not a Lean theorem.

n	$g(n)$ (Thm. 6.1)	$570n + 1\,795\,711$	exponent 658	$\nu(n)$ (numerics)
0	1 795 711	1 795 711	430 010	2
1	1 796 280	1 796 281	430 667	2
10	1 801 401	1 801 411	436 580	3
100	1 852 612	1 852 711	495 711	4
1000	2 364 713	2 365 711	1 087 012	4
10^4	7 485 714	7 495 711	7 000 013	5
10^5	58 695 715	58 795 711	66 130 014	6
10^6	570 795 715	571 795 711	657 430 014	7

The block in $\rho(n)$ is finite because π is irrational, so the Lean definition uses `Nat.find` together with Mathlib's `irrational_pi`. The Lean definition of $\gamma(s)$ returns 0 when no later 1 exists. Every statement below that involves γ carries the hypothesis that some later digit equals 1; we do not prove that this hypothesis holds for every s.

Theorem 7.2 (`piDist_run`). *For every n, $16^{-(\rho(n)+1)} < \delta_n < 16^{-\rho(n)}$.*

Theorem 7.3 (`piNeed_bounds`). *For every n, with $c_n = \lceil \log_{16}(8n + 8\nu(n) + 12) \rceil$,*

$$\rho(n) + c_n \le \nu(n) \le \rho(n) + c_n + 1.$$

In Lean c_n is `Nat.clog 16 (2 * bbpGuardErr n (piNeed n))`, and $2E_{n,\nu(n)} = 8n + 8\nu(n) + 12$. Both inequalities in Theorems 7.2 and 7.3 are sharp in the sense that equality cannot occur in the strict ones: $16^k \delta_n \neq 1$ because π is irrational.

Theorem 7.4 (`forced_chain`). *For every n:*

1. *the digits $d_{n+1}, \dots, d_{n+\rho(n)}$ are not equal to 1;*
2. *if some digit d_{n+1+k} $(k \ge 0)$ equals 1, then $\rho(n) \le \gamma(n+1)$;*
3. *$16^{-(\rho(n)+1)} < \delta_n < 16^{-\rho(n)}$;*
4. *$\rho(n) + c_n \le \nu(n) \le \rho(n) + c_n + 1$;*
5. *the guard agrees at every depth $g \ge \nu(n)$.*

Corollary 7.5 (`long_run_forces`). *If $L \le \rho(n)$, then the digits $d_{n+1}, \dots, d_{n+L}$ are not 1; if moreover some later digit equals 1, then $\gamma(n+1) \ge L$; and $\delta_n < 16^{-L}$ and $\nu(n) \ge L + c_n$.*

So a long run forces a long gap before the next 1, a small distance and a large need. The converse implication fails, and a single kernel-checked example shows it.

Proposition 7.6 (`long_gap_short_run`). *$\rho(77) = 0$ and $\gamma(78) = 49$.*

Proof. The lemma `cert_78_127` checks, by `decide +kernel`, that the certificate's guard agrees at positions $78, \dots, 127$, that $d_{78} = 3$, that none of $d_{78}, \dots, d_{126}$ equals 1, and that $d_{127} = 1$. Theorem 4.2 turns these checks into statements about the true digits. □

Proposition 7.6 shows that a long gap between 1s does not force a run of 0s or Fs, a small δ_n, or a large $\nu(n)$. Supporting lemmas in the same file include the countdown identities `piRun_succ`, `piRun_add` and `piGapSeq_countdown`, the bound `piRun_le_inter_one_gap`, and `piRun_pos_cases`, which records that a nonempty 0-run means x_n lies just above an integer and an F-run that it lies just below one.

8. The Lean development

Toolchain. The development uses Lean `leanprover/lean4:v4.29.0-rc8` and Mathlib at commit `816ff4582a01b10567d1d4ecb10be7c4ff92aab4`, as recorded in `lake-manifest.json`. All proofs are in the namespace `FinitistProved` unless another namespace is shown; the results of Section 7 are in `FinitistProved.PiDigitStructure`.

Axioms and decision procedures. For each theorem in Table 2, `#print axioms` reports no axioms beyond `propext`, `Classical.choice` and `Quot.sound` (`cert_78_127` uses only `propext`); in particular there is no `sorryAx`. Finite computations are checked with `decide +kernel`, so they are evaluated by the kernel; `native_decide`, which would add the compiler to the trusted base, is not used.

Theorem names. Table 2 lists the Lean name, the file and the commit for each numbered result. The results currently live on three branches of the development repository; Section 8.1 describes the single public snapshot that will replace these references.

Table 2. Results and their Lean names. Commits: (a) `2c596fe` (branch `research/sharpen-guard-2`); (b) `881fc80` (branch `research/cap-bracket`); (c) `7d37c5d` (branch `research/digit-structure`). Results marked (a) also exist at (b) and (c) and on `main` (`ad5468a`) unless marked "only". File paths are relative to `Thoughts/`.

Result	Lean name	File (commit)
Thm. 3.1	`bbpSeries_eq_pi`	`Proved/BBPPiIdentity.lean` (a)
Thm. 4.2	`BBPGuardAgreesAt.floor_pi`, `BBPGuardAgreesAt.digit_pi`	`Proved/BBPExplicitGuard.lean` (a)
Lem. 4.3	`guardAgreesAt_of_dist`	`Research/BBPConditionalAllN.lean` (a)
Thm. 5.1	`MahlerSharp7b.pi_pow16_measure7`	`Research/MahlerSharp7b.lean` (a only)
Thm. 6.1	`bbp_digit_all_n_mu570b`, `bbp_guard_mu570b_of_ge`	`Research/BBPMu570b.lean` (a only)
Cor. 6.2	`bbp_digit_all_n_fixed7b`	`Research/BBPMu570b.lean` (a only)
Rem. 6.3	`bbp_digit_all_n_mu658`	`Research/BBPMu658.lean` (a)
Thm. 7.2	`piDist_run`	`Research/PiDigitStructure.lean` (c only)
Thm. 7.3	`piNeed_bounds`	same file (c only)
Thm. 7.4	`forced_chain`, `long_run_forces`	same file (c only)
Prop. 7.6	`long_gap_short_run`, `cert_78_127`	same file (c only)
Thm. A.1	`BBPSpigotDigitCorrect_of_le_10000_unconditional`	`Proved/BBPDigitsUnconditionalExt10000.lean` (b only)
Thm. A.2	`not_BBPSpigotDigitCorrect_window'`, `not_BBPSpigotDigitCorrect_window`	`Research/BBPCapBracket.lean`, `Research/BBPCapRefutation.lean` (b only)

Dependencies. The import closure of `PiDigitStructure.lean` contains seven modules of the development (the BBP algebra, series, tail, guarded-certificate and identity files, a definitions file, and the file itself). The import closures of the main theorem and of the capped-certificate results currently also contain unrelated modules of the same repository; they are not used by the proofs, and the public snapshot removes them.

8.1. **Plan for the public snapshot.** Before publication the theorem references above will be replaced by a single public commit of a separate repository containing only the modules needed for Table 2, with the Mathlib revision fixed in the Lake configuration as well as in the manifest, Mathlib-style names, and a generated axiom report. Table 2 will then cite that one commit.

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The author used AI assistants (Grok Bot) as tools for drafting Lean proofs, running computations and editing this text. All statements were checked by the Lean kernel or, where marked as numerics, by independent computation; the author is responsible for the content.

Appendix A. Future work: the capped certificate

A.1. **Definition.** The development's original certificate does not use an explicit guard. It tries the depths $4, 8, 12, \ldots, 64$ in order and stops at the first depth at which the guard agrees; if none agrees it uses depth 68 (`bbpCertGuard`, `bbpGuardSearch`). Its digit at position n is then compared with d_n; the statement that they are equal is `BBPSpigotDigitCorrect n`. When the search stops at an agreeing depth, Theorem 4.2 applies and the digit is correct. The question is what happens at the positions where no depth up to 64 agrees.

A.2. **What is proved.**

Theorem A.1. *For every $n \le 10000$ the capped certificate returns d_n.*

In Lean this is `BBPSpigotDigitCorrect_of_le_10000_unconditional`. The proof uses a fast natural-number checker (`BBPFastGuard.lean`), proved to agree with the guard test, and checks in the kernel, in blocks, that the guard agrees for each $n \le 10000$ at the depth the search selects; it then applies Theorem 4.2. The bound 10000 reflects the cost of the check, not a mathematical limit.

Theorem A.2. *For every n with $2^{272} - 71 \le n$ and $5n + 348 \le 14 \cdot 2^{272}$, the capped certificate does not return d_n. In particular this holds for every $n \in [2^{272}, 2^{273}]$.*

In Lean these are `not_BBPSpigotDigitCorrect_window'` (general window) and `not_BBPSpigotDigitCorrect_window` (the interval $[2^{272}, 2^{273}]$).

For the positions $10001 \le n \le 2^{272} - 72$ neither correctness nor failure of the capped certificate is proved. We do not claim that it fails there.

A.3. **Mechanism.** For $n \ge 1$ the lower end of the bracket satisfies, at every depth g,

$$16^g x_n - (5K + 3) - 16^g < \mathrm{lo} \cdot 16^g \le 16^g x_n - (K + 2) \qquad (\texttt{guardedLo_position}),$$

with $K = n+g+1$. Thus lo is biased downward from x_n by at least $(K+2)/16^g$. For $n \ge 2^{253}$ no depth up to 64 can agree (`bbpCertGuard_eq_68`), so the search uses $g = 68$. Once $16^{68} \le K + 2$, that is, $n \ge 2^{272} - 71$, the downward bias is at least one unit, while the upper condition $5K + 3 \le 14 \cdot 16^{68}$ keeps lo within the next lower integer; together they force $\mathrm{lo} \bmod 16 \ne d_n$ (`lo_digit_ne_of_window`). Below $2^{272} - 71$ the bias is smaller than one unit, and whether the capped digit is wrong depends on the actual digits of π after position n (roughly, on a run of about $68 - \log_{16} n$ zeros or Fs). No argument in the development decides that.

A.4. **Directions.**

(1) *Sharper constants.* The exponent 570 and the constant B come from the factor 1.4063 in the bound for $\operatorname{lcm}(1,\dots,n)$ and from the other explicit choices in Section 5. Sharper explicit Chebyshev bounds would lower both.
(2) *Kernel-checked tables of $\nu(n)$.* The values in the last column of Table 1 could be turned into kernel-checked statements for explicit ranges, using Theorem 7.3 and the decidable check.
(3) *Finite digit-pattern observations.* A separate computation on $d_0,\dots,d_{100000}$, with positions $n \le 99800$, found the patterns in Observation A.3. These are finite observations, not theorems: they are not proved in Lean, they say nothing about larger n, and several similar patterns that held up to $n \approx 21000$ failed before $n = 99800$.

Observation A.3 (computed, finite range only). On the stated ranges, with ν computed exactly from rational arithmetic:

(1) no hexadecimal digit occurs 5 times in a row in $d_1,\dots,d_{100000}$;
(2) for $n \le 99800$, there are never 4 consecutive gaps of length at least 32 between successive 1s, and never 3 consecutive such gaps of length at least 48;
(3) $\nu(n) \le 10$ for every $n \le 99800$, with equality only at $n = 20174$ and $n = 79938$;
(4) every block of 810 consecutive positions in $[1904, 99800]$ contains an n with $\nu(n) \ge 7$, and every block of 549 consecutive positions in $[161, 99800]$ contains an n with $\nu(n) \ge 6$.

Patterns that held for $n \le 21000$ but not for $n \le 99800$ include: the largest gap between successive 1s grew from 102 to 142; the number of blocks of four equal digits grew from 3 to 20; and the least distance between successive runs of length 3 dropped from 268 to 32.

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